

Exporting in After Effects

And now we come to what must be done once you're happy with the result

This is the final step after your project is complete. Make sure that these 2 things are in place before you export so you don't falter before the finish line:

- Check if your Resolution is at full in the composition panel. (Remember when we dialed the resolution down a notch or two to speed up the RAM preview? This is where it might come back to haunt us if we don't pay attention to it.)
 - Make sure the active time frame encompasses the whole video. If not, you might end up exporting only a portion of your project.
- Avoid these 2 fatal mistakes and you're good to go.

EXPORTING WITH RENDER QUEUE

Click Composition → Add to Render Queue

The timeline panel will change to the rendering mode and you can change some properties of your project before exporting. From this mode you can only export it as a .avi file. Once ready, click on the Render button.

EXPORTING WITH ADOBE MEDIA ENCODER

Click Composition → Add to Media encoder.

A dialog box will open with your project. If you double click it, you can see another dialog box to finalise the properties of your project before exporting. You can select one of the presets to simplify this process.

An advantage of Adobe Media Encoder is that it allows you to continue working on AE while rendering. After picking the destination folder, it will start rendering and exporting once you hit the play button in the top right of the Encoder dialog box. 